

First, map the journey.

Tool 1 asks what a person uses at each step. You can only answer that once you know the steps. So write them down first.

ALREADY HAVE ONE?

Use your journey map or service blueprint. Need a refresher?

[Journey mapping 101 · NN/g](#)

[Service blueprints · NN/g](#)

Experience Map & Blueprint · Nesta DIY Toolkit

NEW TO THIS?

Use the Journey Strip below. For each step, write **where** they are and **what or who** they use. Nothing else.

Journey Strip · Meera

EXAMPLE

STEP	1 Sees the notice	2 Opens the portal	3 Makes the PDF	4 Gets the certificate	5 Enters the OTP	6 Uploads
WHERE	Hostel	Hostel room	Cybercafé	Home village	Hostel	Hostel
USES · WHO HELPS	Class WhatsApp, her phone	Phone, hostel Wi-Fi	₹50, the owner	Father, Tehsildar office	Father's phone	Data pack

Every item in the bottom row becomes something you place on the Loop in Tool 1.

Journey Strip · your person

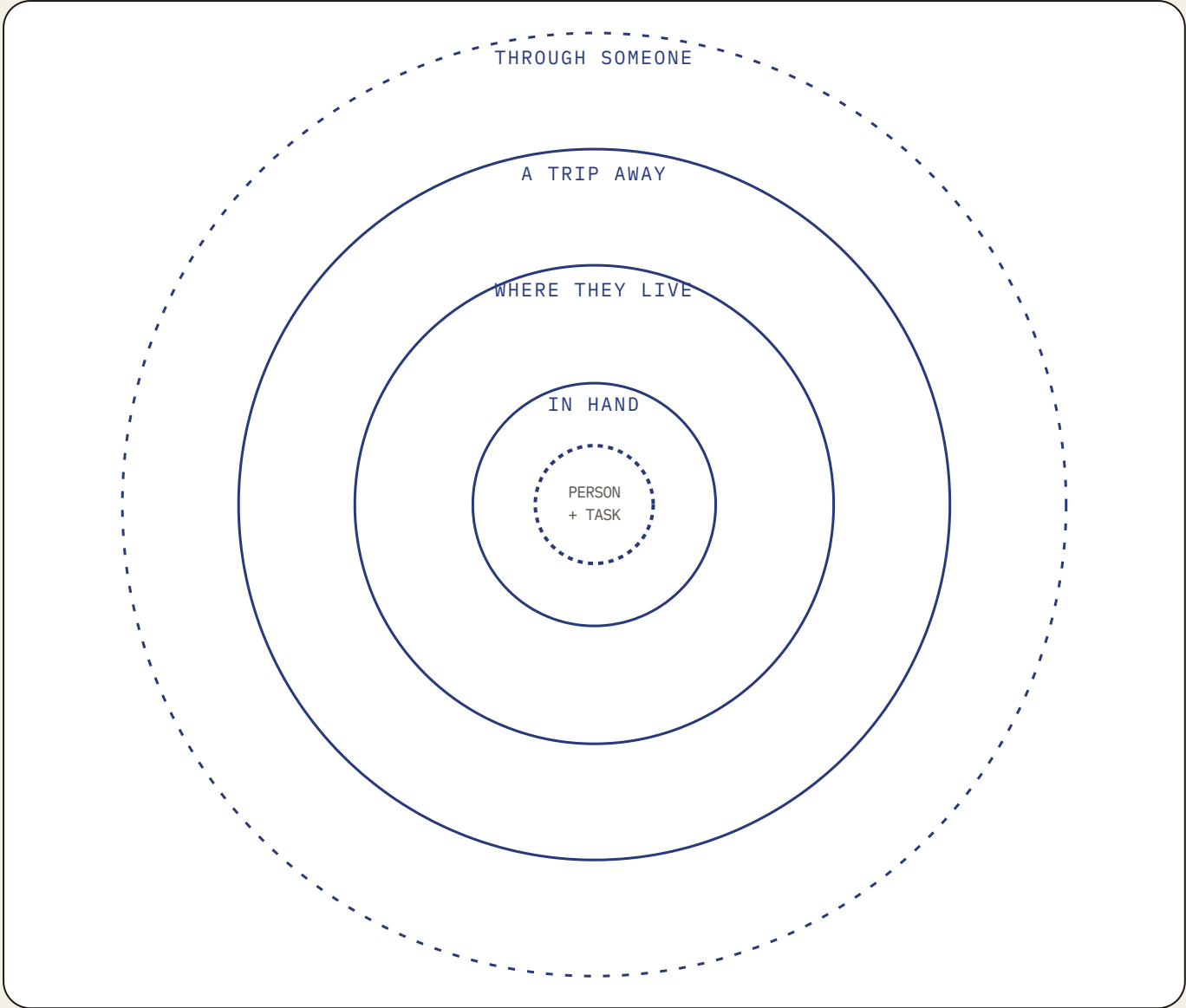
BLANK

STEP	1	2	3	4	5	6
WHERE						
USES · WHO HELPS						

The Loop

BLANK TEMPLATE

PERSON _____ TASK _____ DATE _____



● Person

■ Thing

▲ Place

P1 Photo

Fill: seen · told · assumed Line = one small task. Owns — · borrows - - · pays for ^ . Write the verb on it.

Rings: easy to reach in the centre, hard to reach outside.

Next · Part B, the Ladder →

← HIGHER PRIORITY

LOWER PRIORITY →

Key things → write them in						
Priority: _____						
1 Exists Is it in their world?						
2 Reachable Can they get to it?						
3 Affordable Can they pay once?						
4 Sustainable Does it keep working?						
5 Theirs Owned or borrowed?						
6 Usable Do they know how?						
7 Permitted Allowed to use it?						

- Focus first.** Basic access, high priority.
- Push for change.** Basic access, lower priority.
- Design for next.** Everyday use, high priority.
- Keep an eye on.** Everyday use, lower priority.

Every × you marked can be taken into Tool 2 · Break.

p.4.11 →

The Whisper

BLANK TEMPLATE

BREAK FROM YOUR LADDER _____ STEP _____

THE FACTS • COPY THEM FROM THE ORIGINAL NOTICE, FORM OR MESSAGE

A fact is one piece of information the person needed to get it right.

1

2

3

4

WHO THEY ASKED	WHAT THEY WERE TOLD	1	2	3	4	ADDS
☐ TOLD ☐ SHOWN ☐ SEEN						
☐ TOLD ☐ SHOWN ☐ SEEN						
☐ TOLD ☐ SHOWN ☐ SEEN						
☐ TOLD ☐ SHOWN ☐ SEEN						

BIG PLAYER

In the end, [the café owner] solved it, because they [knew the 200KB "setting"]

Only write what the person tells you, shows you (a chat, a screenshot) or what you see yourself. Fill the dot if the fact survived, cross it if it was lost.

REPEAT FOR EVERY ×

BREAK	HOPS	BIG PLAYER

NEXT **Part B • Big players & the Cut →**

1 • Map. Write each big player in a circle. Draw one line per break that depends on them.

BIG PLAYER

BIG PLAYER

BIG PLAYER

PERSON

BIG PLAYER

BIG PLAYER

BIG PLAYER

2 • Cut. Remove one big player at a time. Start with the one with the most lines.

× CUT:

DEPENDS ON THEM	FALLBACK	OUTCOME ✓ / ×

× CUT:

Without [the café owner], [the upload] stops working and [Meera] pays. The product could share their load by [accepting phone photos]

NEXT

Take the costs and Xs to Tool 3 • Weigh →

What gets compromised first?

BLANK TEMPLATE

SORTING STRIP • LAY THE CARDS HERE

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
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← COMPROMISED FIRST

PROTECTED LAST →

When money or time is short, [savings] goes first. The cost we found, [₹50 café trip], lands on [phone & data]

The order changes when [exams or a festival]

NEED CARDS • CUT OUT

Food	Rent & home	Bills	Health	Education	Phone & data	Travel	Family & festivals	Savings	Add yours
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Translate the cards into the local language, and add a picture to each for people who don't read.

COUNT CARD

FRONT • THE STORY

From Tool __ • step or big player: _____

BACK • THE COUNT

HOW MANY • SOURCE

IN THEIR MONEY

EXPLAINS

NEXT Take your findings to Tool 4 • Say →

The brief pad

BLANK TEMPLATE

BREAK

PERSON

The product assumed...*[a scanner and a PDF]***What existed was...***[a phone camera and a café]***So they...***[paid ₹50 and lost a day]***It cost them...***[money, a day, and her father's time]***This is...**

OVERSIGHT

OFFLOAD

CONSTRAINT

↳ Whose decision was it?**↳ Who benefits · who pays?****↳ Was it intentional?**

YES

NO

NOT SURE

It is true for...*[[n] students in the survey · source]***Prototype next...***[photo-to-PDF inside the upload step]*

Answer the three ↳ questions only if you picked Offload.

IN ONE LINE

Ask Your Participants

Ask about the task, never about what someone lacks.

TOOL 1 · BUILD

"Show me the last time you did this — from the very start."

TOOL 2 · BREAK

"Who did you ask? And who did they ask?"

TOOL 2 · BREAK

"Do you know anyone who tried and gave up?"

TOOL 3 · WEIGH

"When money is short, what gets compromised first?"

CONSENT · READ ALOUD

"There are no right answers. Skip anything, stop any time. We won't use your name, or anyone's who helped you."

CARE

Never ask income
Helpers by role, not name
Sensitive questions in private
Let them hold the cards
Go back and share what you found